MOHNISH SHENDE

OSINT Researcher | Cybersecurity Analyst | Vulnerability Assessment | Intelligence Analysis

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Summary

Cybersecurity and OSINT researcher with experience in vulnerability assessment, Linux infrastructure, security analysis, intelligence-style research, and independent interdisciplinary research. Experienced with Nessus, Burp Suite, Nmap, Python security tooling, Docker-based infrastructure, and self-hosted systems. MSc Cyber Security graduate from an NCSC-certified degree programme with peer-reviewed research experience. Research work spans cybersecurity, forensic psychology, intelligence analysis, political psychology, influence systems, and structured evidence assessment. Experienced in source verification, evidence evaluation, qualitative document analysis, comparative case analysis, construct operationalization, framework development, and communicating uncertainty in technical and research reporting

Experience

Project Associate I

12/2024 - 03/2025

CSIR-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI) — Nagpur, Maharashtra, India

- Assessed internal research networks for vulnerabilities using Nessus and Burp Suite
- Supported network segmentation, access-control configuration, and Linux privilege management
- Documented network baselines, secure-configuration practices, and system-hardening measures
- Produced technical reports and conducted OSINT-based research using SearXNG and other research tools

Projects

NodeZero

Self-Hosted Homelab Infrastructure A reproducible self-hosted infrastructure environment designed around Linux, Docker, internal DNS, HTTPS, remote access, monitoring, backup, and recovery.

- Built and operated a Docker-based self-hosted infrastructure environment
- Implemented internal DNS using Pi-hole and Unbound
- Implemented internal HTTPS and reverse-proxy services using Caddy
- Configured remote access through Tailscale and network file sharing through Samba
- Integrated monitoring through Uptime Kuma and containerized application services
- Documented system architecture, networking, DNS and HTTPS configuration, security controls, services, backups, recovery procedures, and operational runbooks
- Maintained rebuild-from-zero documentation to support reproducibility and disaster recovery

https://github.com/MohnishShende/nodezero

Auditor: A tool that saves your tooling.

Auditor is a linux system audit / snapshot generator.

- It can automatically sanitize secrets for shareable reports, preserve audits as canonical JSON snapshots, compare snapshots to identify configuration drift, and generate Markdown, HTML, and optional PDF reports. An optional self-hosted dashboard provides access to audits, reports, comparisons, and downloadable audit bundles.
- Auditor is designed to inspect a Linux server without changing it. You authenticate with sudo once, and it collects privileged information using least privilege without repeatedly asking for a password.
- It works entirely locally, with no cloud, telemetry, analytics, or AI dependency.
  Its main strength is reconstructing how the server actually fits together, from physical storage and encryption through filesystems and Docker to applications, Caddy, and hostnames.

https://github.com/MohnishShende/auditor/

Education

MSc Cyber Security, Merit

University of Plymouth

09/2023 - 09/2024 United Kingdom

- National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC)-certified degree programme

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Information Technology, Distinction

St. Vincent Pallotti College of Engineering and Technology

02/2018 - 07/2022

Skills

Cybersecurity

Nmap · Nessus · Burp Suite · Vulnerability Assessment · Security Reconnaissance · OSINT · Passive Reconnaissance · Command Allowlisting · Scan-Result Analysis

Systems & Infrastructure

Linux · Debian · Ubuntu · Docker · Docker Compose · Caddy · Pi-hole · Unbound · Tailscale · Samba · SSH · nftables · systemd · Self-Hosted Infrastructure · Internal DNS · Reverse Proxying

Development & Data

Python · Flask · REST APIs · XML · JSON · Markdown · requests · xmltodict · tracemalloc · Ollama · Local LLM Integration

Projects

ECI EVM Engineering Assurance Assessment

Independent engineering-assurance assessment applying structured evidence analysis to claims concerning Indian Electronic Voting Machine systems

- Extracted and normalized technical claims from source material
- Developed traceability between claims, evidence, and analytical conclusions
- Distinguished directly supported evidence from inference, uncertainty, and unsupported assertions
- Applied structured evidence evaluation to produce an auditable engineering-assurance framework

https://github.com/MohnishShende/ECI-EVM-Engineering-Assurance

Somerton Man Research Dossier

Independent evidence-based investigation and long-form research dossier

- Conducted source analysis, claim verification, chronology reconstruction, and uncertainty assessment
- Classified sources and analytical conclusions by evidentiary strength and confidence
- Maintained a version-controlled research dossier designed to preserve traceability between evidence and conclusions

Identity-Based Identification Schemes

Python implementation of identity-based identification and zero-knowledge authentication concepts

- Implemented educational demonstrations of EZKP, Fiat-Shamir, Sakai-Kasahara, TNCIBI, and TwinSchnorr-related schemes
- Developed Flask endpoints and supporting clients for protocol experimentation
- Used timing and memory measurements, including tracemalloc, for implementation analysis
- Developed as an educational/research implementation rather than a production authentication system

https://github.com/MohnishShende/IBI-schemes

Publications

Psychological Appropriation: A Dimensional Model of Surrogate-Moral Violence

12/2025

Journal of Forensic Psychology Research and Practice

Shende, M

Psychological Appropriation describes a surrogate-driven form of moral violence in which offenders believe they are acting empathically, protectively, or redemptively on behalf of others. It reframes moralized violence as a distortion of empathy rather than its absence. This paper introduces a dimensional framework that situates the construct within psychotic personality organization and outlines five interacting domains: Surrogate Identification, Moralized Logic, Symbolic Consent, Affective Idealization, and Narrative Ritualization. Applied to the cases of Adam Lanza and Charles Cullen, the model shows how surrogate morality transforms care into compulsion and provides a unified structure for understanding symbolic and surrogate-moral violence.

https://doi.org/10.1080/24732850.2025.2599908

The Operating Manual: Meditations on the Mind, Judgment, and Living Well (English Edition)

2025

Amazon

Mohnish Shende

The Operating Manual is a practical guide to understanding the ways emotion, stress, mood, exhaustion, uncertainty, and cognitive bias can influence perception and judgment.
Rather than offering formulas for happiness or promising personal transformation, this book begins with a simpler problem: how do you think clearly when your own mind is under pressure?
Written as a manual to return to when needed, it explores how judgment can change during depression, anxiety, anger, shame, loneliness, exhaustion, hypomania and mania, as well as during ordinary periods of stress and uncertainty.

https://www.amazon.in/dp/B0HDLF7HKN

Skills

Research & Intelligence Analysis

OSINT Research · Source Verification · Evidence Evaluation · Source Triangulation · Confidence Assessment · Chronology Reconstruction · Qualitative Document Analysis · Comparative Case Analysis · Process Tracing · Mechanism Coding · Construct Operationalization · Framework Development · Structured Evidence Assessment · Research Writing · Technical Reporting

Languages

English	Native
Marathi	Native
Hindi	Native

Awards

MSc Cyber Security, NCSC-Certified Degree Programme
Academic Year 2023-2024

Interests

- Cybersecurity
- OSINT
- Intelligence Analysis
- Forensic Psychology
- Threat Assessment
- Political Psychology
- Influence and Persuasion
- Structured Evidence Analysis
- Security Research

ACADEMIA

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